# Development Capital Plan

*$7 million to convert a 10 kW thesis into PDR-quality evidence*

**Compute where space data begins.**

> Recommendation: raise $7 million now for team, ground validation, mission definition, customer proof and supplier-backed PDR evidence. Do not present the round as financing the complete flight system.

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Satellite Inference™ is currently operated by RFID INC, a Delaware corporation.

Version: Fundraising Roadmap v0.1 | Public Planning Draft

Date: 2 September 2026

Evidence cut-off: 2 September 2026

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> This document is an engineering and business planning paper. It is not flight-release documentation, legal advice, an offer to sell securities or a solicitation to purchase securities. Technical figures remain subject to analysis, supplier quotations, verification, licensing and customer requirements.

DECISION

# 1. Financing recommendation

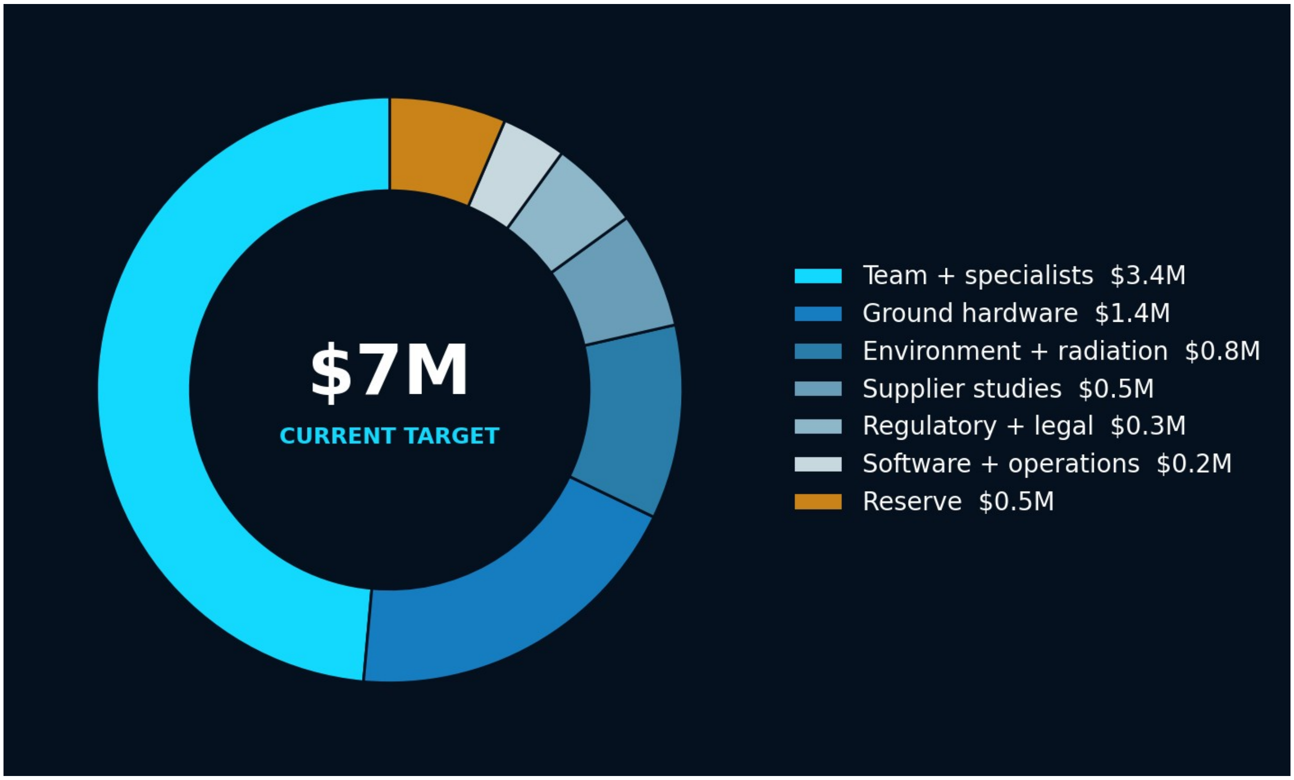
**RECOMMENDATION**

Proceed with preparation for a $7 million seed financing. Use the capital to close technical and commercial uncertainty through PDR. Defer a $100 million-plus first-node program financing until customer, supplier and engineering gates are met.

| Question | Answer |
|---|---|
| Why not $500k-$1M? | It is unlikely to fund the multi-discipline team, 10 kW ground system, supplier studies and customer pilots needed to make the large concept credible. |
| Why not $100M now? | Without a team, PDR-quality design, customer reservations and supplier-backed cost, the ask would combine avoidable technical, commercial and execution risk. |
| What does $7M buy? | A credible next financing: technical evidence, customer evidence, architecture, interfaces, ROMs, risk retirement and program governance. |
| Does $7M launch the node? | No. It is development capital and should not be described as full mission funding. |

$7 MILLION PLANNING ALLOCATION

## 2. Use of funds




| Workstream | $M | % | Evidence purchased |
|---|---|---|---|
| Core engineering team and specialists | 3.40 | 49% | Systems, power, thermal, compute, software and program leadership |
| Compute, power and thermal ground hardware | 1.35 | 19% | Measured 1 kW tile and 10 kW system evidence |
| Environmental and radiation testing | 0.75 | 11% | Qualification plan and critical-part characterization |
| Supplier studies and preliminary integration | 0.45 | 6% | ROMs, interfaces, architecture and gate packages |
| Regulatory, export, security and legal | 0.35 | 5% | Early licensing, data and compliance path |
| Software, data, facilities and operations | 0.25 | 4% | Runtime, datasets, evaluations and company infrastructure |
| Program reserve | 0.45 | 6% | Schedule, supplier, test and hiring uncertainty |
| Total | 7.0 | 100% | PDR-quality technical and commercial program |

This is a planning allocation for approximately 15-18 months, not a board-approved budget or offering term. Hiring geography, compensation, facility costs, supplier payment schedules and the financing instrument will change the final cash plan.

WHAT INVESTORS SHOULD EXPECT

## 3. Milestone contract for the round

| Milestone | Objective evidence | Failure signal |
|---|---|---|
| Founding technical team | Named leaders covering systems, power/thermal, compute/software and program execution | Critical roles remain outsourced without accountable owners |
| 1 kW engineering tile | 1,000-hour representative workload, measured power/thermal balance and fault recovery | Thermal or stability limits prevent replication |
| 10 kW ground breadboard | Continuous full-load system with orchestration and N-1 behavior | Facility-only result cannot map to a plausible flight architecture |
| Customer evidence | Two paid evaluations and one conditional anchor reservation | Only non-binding interest without price or workload |
| Supplier evidence | ROMs and interface studies for bus, power, battery, thermal, comms, test and launch | Key suppliers cannot meet requirement, schedule or export path |
| SRR/PDR | Traceable requirements, selected architecture, budgets, CAD concept, V&V and risk register | Margins or interfaces remain unbounded |
| Next-round package | Costed flight plan, team, customer and technical diligence room | Capital need remains a narrative rather than an underwritten program |

MATCH INSTRUMENT TO RISK

# 4. Staged capital architecture

| Stage | Planning amount | Primary use | Entry gate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Development seed | $7M | Team, ground evidence, SRR/PDR and customer proof | Current |
| Flight-development | $25-40M | Detailed design, engineering models, long-lead development and qualification | PDR plus anchor evidence |
| First-node program | $100-150M | Flight units, integration, launch, commissioning and working capital | Supplier-backed plan plus material contracted demand |
| Fleet expansion | $200M+ | Manufacturing, launches, network and customer capacity | Stable operations and replication economics |

## Potential capital mix

| Capital source | Best use | Constraint |
|---|---|---|
| Venture equity / SAFE | Team and platform development before revenue | Dilution and milestone credibility |
| Strategic investment | Supplier, semiconductor, EO or network alignment | Commercial restrictions and signaling |
| Government non-dilutive | Dual-use R&D, testing and mission demonstrations | Schedule, eligibility, scope and procurement rules |
| Customer-funded engineering | Workload port, sensor interface and security integration | Customer-specific scope and IP |
| Capacity reservation / prepayment | Long-lead flight procurement after confidence grows | Refund, delay and mission-loss terms |
| Asset or project financing | Later replicated spacecraft with contracted cash flows | Not credible before operations and contracts |

CONTEXT, NOT VALUATION

## 5. Financing precedents

| Company | Disclosed financing | Stage evidence at announcement | Relevance |
|---|---|---|---|
| Orbital Compute | $5M pre-seed, June 2026 | Hosted GPU pathfinder planned for 2027 plus purpose-built satellite development | Shows small validation capital can precede a larger architecture |
| Loft Orbital | $170M Series C, January 2025 | Five launched satellites, more than 30 sold, $500M lifetime bookings disclosed | Large capital followed fleet and commercial evidence |
| Starcloud | $170M Series A, March 2026 | Disclosed H100 orbital demonstration and next-generation program | Large round followed an on-orbit technical proof |
| Starcloud | $250M extension, August 2026 | Further scale financing and strategic participation disclosed | Demonstrates sector capital availability after visible execution |

**COMP** **LIMITATION**

These announcements are context comps only. They do not support a Satellite Inference valuation, price, round probability or investor demand. Company-reported claims should be diligence-checked before investor circulation.

### Implication

The market has funded both low-cost validation and much larger scale rounds. The common pattern is not size alone; it is a visible step-up in evidence. Satellite Inference should use $7 million to create the evidence that makes a later flight-development and first-node financing underwritable.

PUBLIC PLANNING FRAMEWORK

# 6. Investor architecture and message

| Tier | Investor type | Why fit | Likely objection | Proof required |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Deep-tech and space specialists | Can underwrite hardware, long schedules and mission risk | 10 kW is ahead of customer proof | Team, ground demo and paid design partners |
| 1 | Defense and dual-use specialists | Mission-assured edge outcomes and government pathways | Procurement timing and classification | Named use case and transition path |
| 1 | Strategic semiconductor, EO or network partners | Platform, sensor or communications leverage | Channel conflict and exclusivity | Open interfaces and bounded strategic rights |
| 2 | Generalist frontier-technology funds | Large market narrative and staged platform | Capital intensity and long time to revenue | Milestone economics and syndicate plan |
| 2 | Family offices and sovereign innovation capital | Long-duration infrastructure appetite | Governance and export restrictions | Counsel-reviewed structure and technical advisory bench |
| 3 | Infrastructure capital | Later contracted fleet cash flows | No operating asset or predictable revenue yet | Defer until first-node service and contracts |

## Core message

Satellite Inference is building mission-assured processing for data generated in space. The company is not raising $7 million to launch a speculative data center. It is raising $7 million to prove the 10 kW architecture on the ground, secure customer and supplier evidence, and reach a PDR-quality decision point for a staged flight program.

PROTECT CAPITAL DISCIPLINE

# 7. Go / no-go controls

| Decision | Go trigger | No-go or redesign trigger |
|---|---|---|
| Freeze 10 kW mission | Customer benchmarks show sustained multi-tenant or high-rate need | Embedded sub-kW processing meets the outcome materially cheaper |
| Enter PDR | 10 kW ground thermal and power balance closes with plausible flight mapping | Heat transport or deployed area lacks feasible supplier path |
| Raise flight-development capital | PDR package plus conditional anchor and supplier ROMs | Customer interest lacks price, minimum volume or procurement path |
| Place non-refundable launch orders | Mass, envelope, orbit, schedule, licenses and 50% contracted target revenue | Launch quote is based on placeholder geometry or uncontracted demand |
| Replicate fleet | Ninety days stable operation, p95 SLA, paid utilization above 60% and expansion | First node requires heroic operations or economics do not replicate |

## Immediate 90-day work

1. Recruit accountable technical leadership and establish requirements, configuration and evidence control.
2. Select three workloads and acquire representative datasets with explicit rights.
3. Build the first 1 kW tile and define the 10 kW facility test architecture.
4. Obtain supplier ROMs and interface studies for the major spacecraft workstreams.
5. Convert customer conversations into two paid evaluations and one conditional capacity reservation framework.
6. Prepare a counsel-reviewed financing process, diligence room and milestone-linked operating model.

DILIGENCE POSTURE

## 8. Sources and caveats

[1] Orbital Compute, $5 million pre-seed announcement. https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/06/09/3308756/0/en/orbital-raises-oversubscribed-5m-pre-seed-round-to-build-ai-data-centers-in-space.html

[2] Loft Orbital, $170 million Series C. https://loftorbital.com/announcing-lofts-170m-series-c/

[3] Starcloud, $170 million Series A announcement. https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260330024111/en/CORRECTING-and-REPLACING-Starcloud-Raises-$170M-Series-A-at-$1.1bn-Valuation-Led-by-Benchmark-and-EQT-Ventures

[4] Starcloud, $250 million Series A extension announcement. https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260821884035/en/Starcloud-Raises-$250-Million-at-$2.3-Billion-Valuation-to-Scale-AI-with-Orbital-Data-Centers

[5] GAO-26-107959, DOD use of commercial space data and services. https://files.gao.gov/reports/GAO-26-107959/index.html

[6] BlackSky 2025 Form 10-K. https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1753539/000175353926000032/bksy-20251231.htm

[7] BlackSky, nearly $30 million assured contract. https://ir.blacksky.com/news-events/press-releases/news-details/2026/BlackSky-Wins-Nearly-30-Million-One-Year-Assured-Contract-from-International-Defense-Customer/default.aspx

Market data and financing announcements are time-sensitive. Refresh them before an active financing launch. Investor outreach, offering terms, public statements and any use of forward-looking financial information require counsel and compliance review.

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